Book Reviews

AKH — UNE NOTION RELIGIEUSE DANS L'ÉGYPTE PHARAONIQUE, by *Gertie Englund* (Acta Universitatis Upsaliensis, Boreas: Uppsala Studies in Ancient Mediterranean and Near Eastern Civilizations, 11) Uppsala, 1978.

This excellent study analyzes the notion of *3ḫ* by surveying its uses in the mortuary texts of the Old, Middle, and New Kingdoms. The first chapter deals with Pyramid Texts, the second with Coffin Texts, and the third with the Book of the Dead. A brief fourth chapter covers the New Kingdom books of the underworld, including the Amduat, the Book of the Adoration of Re in the West, the Book of Gates, the Book of Caverns, and the Book of the Creation of the Solar Disc. A conclusion with final remarks on *3ḫ* ends the study. Englund presents her analysis in a clear and systematic manner, dividing each chapter into three main sections. Section A covers the word *3ḫ*, including its orthography and grammatical usage. Section B details the notion of *3ḫ*, as it relates to: 1. divinities, entities, persons, and, often, objects, 2. localities and spheres, 3. how to become/be an *3ḫ*, and 4. its circumstances and effects. Section C presents a summary of ideas and a comparison of those ideas with the ideas expressed in previous chapters. Preceding each of topics 1–4 is a comprehensive catalogue of the relevant textual passages on *3ḫ*. Through examination of the texts the author explores *3ḫ* as an entity, a state of being, and as a power in an attempt to understand how the Egyptians perceived the concept, and how it evolved in their thought. A point which should be noted, however, is that in referring only rarely to the secular texts this work is not an analysis of *3ḫ* in general in pharaonic Egypt, as the title suggests, but of *3ḫ* specifically in the mortuary literature of that period.

In laying the groundwork for her study, Englund suitably begins with the fact that *3ḫ* is denoted in the texts by an ibis comata. She reviews some of the interpretations for this phenomenon, such as Kees', that the Egyptians perceived apparitions of the dead in the bird due to its glorious plummage, or Daumas' that the relationship between bird and concept rests on their being homonyms.[1] Englund concludes that since we don't know when or how the concept originally developed, the problem of the bird-idea relationship is ultimately insoluble.

Daumas' suggestion, however, may come close to the truth. There is abundant evidence in the secular texts for *3ḫ* with the meaning of "effectiveness" in daily affairs, and it is not unreasonable to believe that this notion was allied as a homonym to the crested ibis *3ḫ*, in which case no conceptual association between the two necessarily existed. Through correlation with the bird, nuances of meaning associated with the bird's brilliant plummage relating to the stars or the sun, could have readily been transferred to the notion of *3ḫ*-effectiveness, thereby broadening and enriching its basic meaning. Given this view, *3ḫ* is a notion arising out of the affairs of men and only secondarily projected into the cosmic sphere.

A number of scholars, however, see the root meaning of *3ḫ* in "to shine," its original meaning being that of a luminous state of being beyond that of earthly existence which was later applied to the deceased and superterrestrial beings (p. 17). Given this interpretation, *3ḫ* finds its primary source in the cosmos and is only later correlated with the deceased as a transcendent being of light, akin to the splendid ibis, the stars, and the sun.

These two approaches represent contrasting methodologies: does the *3ḫ* notion extend from man to heaven or from heaven to man? Is it a concept grounded in the everyday affairs of men or arising out of the ancients' experience of the heavens? Since Englund views "creation and its evolution as a descent of the divine into matter" and the destiny of the deceased as a "reascension by this same path in order to retrieve . . . the Great God" (p. 97), it is not surprising that she perceives *3ḫ* as a notion extending from heaven to man. *3ḫ* is a creative power of heaven, of primordial unity as she calls it (p. 207), belonging to the supreme god whose ultimate prototype is Atum (p. 205). By primordial, Englund means the *i3ḫw*, which she translates, despite its regular sun's rays determinative, as heavens. In this milieu *3ḫ*, "an energetic state which is suitable for the sky" (p. 155), is integrated with Atum the creator (see *CT* 312, *BD* 78). It is in this context of primordial creation that Englund links *3ḫ* with light, since "the creative act in Egypt, as elsewhere, is allied to the idea of the birth of light" (p. 205).

With regard to the more pragmatic meaning of *3ḫ* as "effectiveness," Englund argues against the meaning of utility in general in the mortuary literature, though she accepts it in the secular texts (p. 27). While I agree with

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her that the same word can carry both a sacred and profane meaning, I believe a nexus should be broached. That the funerary texts define 3ḫ as a metaphysical concept of creative power is true. But I would argue that the notion of effectiveness is present in the mortuary usage of the term just as it is in the secular usage. It is important, therefore, to look to the secular texts, if only briefly, to survey how the concept was being utilized concurrent with its usage in the funerary texts; for in the secular texts the evidence is overwhelmingly affirmative in marking 3ḫ as a notion of pragmatic effectiveness implicit in the everyday affairs of king and private individual alike.

For example, the king is 3ḫ to the gods and performs 3ḫw for them. Sesostris I is announced to the Ennead at Karnak: *m33 3ḫ s3 n ỉr sw*,[2] "See, 3ḫ-effective is the son to him who made him," a statement which points up a notion of reciprocity between king and god[3] (son and father). The most common means by which the king is 3ḫ-effective to his god is by means of building him monuments. For example, Seti I "has made (it) as his monument for his father" . . . *m k3t mnḫt nt ḏt m ỉrr s3 ỉr 3ḫwt*[4] "namely, effective works of eternity being what the son does who performs 3ḫwt." The king is 3ḫ-effective with regard not only to his gods, but to his predecessors[5] and subjects[6] as well, just as an official on a lower level of the social hierarchy is 3ḫ with respect to his lord: *3ḫ sw m ỉb n nb.f*[7] "3ḫ-effective is he (the official) in the heart of his lord;" or to his king: *ỉnk s3* (or *b3?*).*k 3ḫ n nb.f*[8] "I am your son who is 3ḫ-effective for his lord;" or to his god: *ỉnk ỉr 3ḫw n/// . . . ///bw nfr n ḥwt-nṯr tn*[9] "It is I who did 3ḫw for . . . (and) good things for this temple;" or he may have knowledge of what is 3ḫ for himself; *ỉw.ỉ rḫ.kwỉ 3ḫt nb(t) n.ỉ m ḫrt-nṯr*[10] "I know all that is 3ḫ-effective for me in the necropolis," and *rḫ.kwỉ 3ḫ.s* (i.e., *M3ᶜt*) *n ỉrr sy tp t3* "I knew that it (Maat) was 3ḫ-effective for him who performed it on earth."[11]

As demonstrated in this brief overview of passages from secular texts, 3ḫ represents a fundamentally pragmatic notion of effectiveness. From this context it may well have been projected into the realm of the Afterlife where it assumed additional nuances of meaning, especially relating to the undying effectiveness of stellar and solar luminosity. There is no question that 3ḫ in the mortuary literature is a more transcendent notion than that expressed in the secular texts. But the concept of effectiveness is still clearly present albeit in a more rarified context.

While I diverge from Englund's point of departure, from this point on, I am in fundamental agreement with her conclusions. For example, she notes, as one of the key features of her study, that 3ḫ is a power of creation which operates within a structure of polarities comprising unity. It arises most especially out of the primordial sphere, but derives from the funerary realm as well (both being states of inertia), and is allied to both Re (or Atum) and Osiris, prototypes of 3ḫ throughout the texts, who bestow 3ḫ through gift or order to men or other gods. The deceased who is rendered 3ḫ is living and in full corporeal form, the latter being a point which is not adequately stressed. He is also, as Englund notes, empowered with liberty to leave the tomb, to participate in divine life, to acquire divine prerogatives and ultimately to join with the supreme god, e.g., Atum, in Coffin Texts (p. 172). One of the most insightful points the author makes about 3ḫ, and one which arises out of its bipolar structure, is that 3ḫ is both a potential and manifest state of being, exemplified mythically through Re (or Atum) and Osiris. She notes for example, that, in Pyramid Texts, Re is potentially 3ḫ at night in Nut, and manifestly 3ḫ at dawn; Osiris is potentially 3ḫ in death in Nedit, manifestly 3ḫ in the form of his son, Horus (p. 31). In Coffin Text 312, an encapsulation of the most metaphysical features of the 3ḫ concept, Atum is at once potentially and manifestly 3ḫ "before, at the time of and after creation" (p. 205). In the Book of the Dead and the New Kingdom compositions, in which the dominant theme is the Re-Osiris synthesis (implicitly present since Pyramic Texts, see e.g., § 585 a, 636 c), a fuller unity and interdependence between these two gods as representatives of the manifest and potential, dynamic and static aspects of 3ḫ is expressed (pp. 209–10). These gods, who provide the mythic prototype for the deceased, are simultaneously creators and their own creation, at once father and son, self-begetters like Re who in the course of his daily transformations ever brings himself into being; or Osiris who with Horus comes into being as the father through the son and the son through the father. By coalescing with these models of unity, the deceased becomes an 3ḫ and gains entry into the mystery of the cycle of life and death.

Another important means by which the individual becomes 3ḫ (and often 3ḫ ᶜpr and 3ḫ ỉkr[12]) is through knowledge. Interestingly, this notion is known from Old Kingdom private tomb inscriptions, but is unknown in the royal Pyramid Texts (the king may have had no need to prove himself through mortal knowledge). It is emphasized in Coffin Texts (p. 109), the focus being on the private individual, but is given scant attention in the Book of the Dead (p. 172), while it is again stressed in the New Kingdom compositions of the royal tombs where it is now perceived as a means of redemption, which Englund interprets as a kind of gnosis (p. 197). How this notion of 3ḫ operates relative to knowledge concurrently in the private and royal spheres is an area which can be profitably investigated further.

3ḫ can also function as an individual on earth as well as in the Beyond. Though there are intimations of this idea since Pyramid Texts, it is the Book of the Dead which specifies that the 3ḫ state can be attained on earth by one who recites the proper efficacious spells,

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indicating that these texts were used by the living, perhaps in an initiation process (pp. 171–72).

The relationship of *3ḫ* and *b3*, which frequently overlap in function, continues to be a troublesome issue. Pyramid Texts offer few problems (but see *Pyr.* § 178d N), but later texts assert that the *3ḫ* has a *b3*, the *b3* has an *3ḫ*, the *b3* is *3ḫ*, and the *b3* is rendered *3ḫ*, the two entities existing in parallel (p. 208, cf. p. 166) and sometimes interchangeably (p. 173). It is striking that a hybrid spelling of *b3/3ḫ* occurs in the Book of Caverns and the Book of the Creation of the Solar Disc () (p. 178). One idea which should be noted is that in some instances *b3* as perceptible form can serve as the manifest form of *3ḫ*, thus enabling the *3ḫ* to act and move; and yet a manifest form of *3ḫ* alone can also serve this function (p. 123). An area to investigate may be whether *3ḫ* and *b3*, as well as the other modes of existence, derive from early and disparate Egyptian religious traditions which at an early point coalesced, resulting in a certain redundancy of functions and meanings.[13]

3ḫ also exists as an entity in the Afterlife. Being a primordial creative energy beyond the categories of good and evil, *3ḫ* produces both benign and malevolent entities of the Beyond which, Englund posits, may be personifications or hypostatized forms of *3ḫ* energy, as Hike personifies the creative energy, *ḥk3w* (p. 207).

One final, but highly important point. In her translations Englund mistakenly resists (though not completely) *3ḫ* in the *sḏm.f* form and instead stresses its usage primarily as a substantive. Thus, in the construction *3ḫ n* she translates "*3ḫ* est à." Though she correctly discounts the translation "it goes well with," a phrase devoid of religious meaning and inappropriate in the religious texts, I view the *3ḫ n* construction as verbal and construe it as a *sḏm.f*[14] form of the adjective-verb which can function as an emphatic and which in many instances can elucidate the meaning of a text. A brief reference to a Coffin Text passage demonstrates the use of *3ḫ* as effectiveness in a *sḏm.n.f* emphatic construction:

> Transforming into Lower Egyptian barley (*ỉt mḥw*). This N is this bush (*b3t*) of life which came forth from Osiris, which grew on he ribs of Osiris, which enlivened mankind, which divinized gods, which made *3ḫ* the *3ḫw*, . . . which caused the living to grow, which made enduring the limbs of the living. This N lives on smoked grain (*npr ḥty*). This N is the smoked grain of the living . . . *3ḫ.n 3st n Ḥr nṯr.s ḫnm.s ỉm.f n Ḥr nṯr.s*. It is for the sake of Horus her god that Isis has become *3ḫ*,[15] she being joyful[16] through (or: with) it (i.e. the grain) for the sake of Horus her god.[17] It is this N who lived and came forth from Osiris. Transforming into Lower Egyptian barley. (*CT* IV 6b–71)

The barley grain in this extraordinarily rich and complex passage, is an Osirian symbol of renewal which operates on a number of levels. The barley grain = the deceased = the *b3t*-plant of life = the smoked grain = Osiris = Horus. The grain denotes the unity of the dead and the living in the trodden and sprouting grain which are Osiris and Horus, father and son. As the *b3t*-plant springs from Osiris' body like the grain (cf. "corn" Osiris figures), so the deceased N, as Horus the son, arises from his father. While N represents in this passage Horus the grain, N is by definition in Coffin Texts Osiris as well, just as the grain in Egyptian religious thinking is equated with Osiris. Thus when N/Horus becomes the grain he is also becoming his father Osiris (the grain being a model of self-begetting unity comparable with Re). These images of vegetative rebirth of son out of father suggest yet another means by which Horus was born, namely through Osiris' insemination of Isis. The Osiris grain in this context functions as husband to Isis. She becomes impregnated with Horus probably through ingestion of the grain seed (= semen), ingestion and insemination being often associated in the ancient's mind.[18] As the text makes clear through the use of an emphatic *sḏm.n.f*, it is for the sake of her son Horus that Isis is *3ḫ*, i.e., actively, effectively involved as mother and wife in this transformation of her son's becoming his father, which represents a cycle of union and renewal exemplified by the grain; and she is joyful through or with the grain because it is her son and husband and by association every deceased.

Despite these criticisms of Dr. Englund's work, which are largely a difference in point of view and emphasis,[19] I recommend this study without reservation as a thorough and important contribution to the understanding of *3ḫ* in the mortuary literature of pharaonic Egypt. It succeeds not only because of Dr. Englund's fine scholarship, but because of her sensitivity to Egyptian methods of thinking which embrace analogues, homologues, and polarities as the structure within which the concept of *3ḫ* operates.

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[1] Not uncommonly, scholars remark that the notion of *3ḫ* was originally consubstantial with the bird form. But it is important to note that while this speculation is tempting, and perhaps intuitively correct (indeed the Egyptians did relate birds to ideas of primordial creative power, see e.g. *JNES* 19, 253), there is lamentably little, if any evidence for it relative to *3ḫ*. And unlike *b3*, which by the New Kingdom represents the deceased

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as a human-headed bird, the deceased is never at any period, to my knowledge, represented by a human-headed ibis nor envisioned as incarnate in the bird. For example, on Dynasty 19 Deir el Medina stelae dedicated to the *3ḫ iḳr n Rᶜ*, the *3ḫ iḳr* deceased is depicted as a standing or seated man and never as a bird.

[2] From P. Lacau & H. Chevrier, *Une Chapelle de Sésostris Ier à Karnak* (Caire, 1956), 49, who translate "See the brilliance (l'éclat) of the son of him who made him." Gun Björkman, *Kings at Karnak* (Uppsala, 1971), 24 and Elke Blumenthal, *Untersuchungen zum ägyptischen Königtum des Mittleren Reiches I, Die Phräseologie*, Abhandlungen der Sächsischen Akademie der Wissenschaften zu Leipzig, Band 61, Heft 1 (Berlin, 1970), 72, translate the phrase using *3ḫ* as an adjective-verb. Björkman translates "The son is good to the one who created him" and Blumenthal "Seht, dass der Sohn herrlich ist für den, der ihn geschaffen hat (= Amun)."

[3] Björkman, *op. cit.*; 23 and n. 3; 24.

[4] K. A. Kitchen, *Ramesside Inscriptions*, Historical and Biograpical (Oxford, 1973), I Fascicle 4, 106, 7/8 and 9/10.

[5] Kitchen, *op. cit.* 4, 109, 13–16.

[6] W. Erichsen, *Papyrus Harris*, Bibliotheca Aegyptiaca V (Bruxelles, 1933), I 1, 6; James Henry Breasted, *Ancient Records of Egypt* (Chicago, 1906), IV, 183, 5.

[7] Blumenthal, *op. cit.*, 296, G 3.2.

[8] *Urk.* IV, 208, 6, cited by Björkman, *op. cit.*, 23, n. 4.

[9] E. Jelinkova-Reymond, "Quelques Recherches sur les Reformes d'Amasis," *ASAE* 54 (1957), 273.

[10] *Urk.* I, 218, 6.

[11] A. H. Gardiner, *Egyptian Grammar*, 3rd Edition (London, 1969), 312. I suggest that a notion of reciprocity, through being and knowing *3ḫ* or performing *3ḫw* in exchange for some benefit, is not only implicit in these statements but in the mortuary texts as well, where not uncommonly the notion of Maat is also associated with *3ḫ* just as in the secular texts.

[12] In a Book of the Dead passage the deceased enters as an ignorant one and goes forth as an *3ḫ iḳr* which, in my opinion, defines itself as "knowledgeable one" (Ch. 64.19, *Pap. of Iouiya* and cf. also Nav. II 264.4–5). This term, *3ḫ iḳr*, is absent in Pyramid Texts, rare in Coffin Texts, and frequent in the Book of the Dead, where, I believe, it denotes most especially an existential, as well as physical, change in the deceased.

[13] Suggested in conversation by Thomas O. Lambdin, Department of Near Eastern Languages, Harvard University.

[14] For other uses of *3ḫ* in the *sḏm.n.f* form, a subject on which I am presently preparing an article, see e.g., *Pyr.* 151d–e, 212a, and 779a–b. This construction was touched on by Sethe in his translation of *Pyr.* 350c as "Er ist Geist geworden" (*3ḫ.n.f*) in *Komm.* II, p. 48. Edel in *AAG* 996 rejected Sethe's use of *3ḫ* as "to become" a spirit, although earlier in *MDAIK* 13, 84 § 22 he translated *3ḫ* as "verklärt werden." Gardiner maintained that with rare exceptions adjective-verbs do not appear in the *sḏm.n.f* form (see *Gr.* §§ 141 and OBS. 1, 144,3 and 145). More recent scholars, however, have approached the problem anew. See e.g., Tom Logan in *ARCE* Newsletter 80, Jan. 1972, p. 37 and references in the unpublished dissertations of Edmund S. Meltzer, "Problems of Adjectival Constructions in Old and Middle Egyptian," Toronto, 1979, and Jim Allen, "The Inflection of the Verb in the Pyramid Texts," Chicago, 1980, the latter soon to be published. David Silverman, who brought these more recent works to my notice, also deals with the adjective-verb in *sḏm.n.f* form in *Interrogative Constructions with* jn *and* jn-jw *in Old and Middle Egyptian*, Malibu, 1980, p. 7, Ex. 10.

[15] Englund translates, "Le *3ḫ* d'Isis est à Horus, son dieu" p. 71, and see also pp. 69 and 79.

[16] *Ḥnm.s* as a circumstantial *sḏm.f*. Although I have followed T1L's reading of *3ḫ.n 3st* instead of Sq6C's *3ḫ 3st*, I believe that *ḫnm.s* without preceding *n* in Sq6C gives a better reading contextually than T1L's *n ḫnms.s*, which is nonetheless grammatically possible.

[17] Faulkner translates this passage "Beneficial is Isis to Horus her god, she is friendly thereby to Horus her god," in *The Ancient Egyptian Coffin Texts*, I (Warminster, 1973), p. 205, Spell 269. In support of this translation he advises "For *3ḫ n 3st* 'it goes well with Isis' of T1L, read *3ḫ 3st* 'beneficial is Isis' with Sq6C." But he then notes that "the significance of *im.f* in the continuation is not certain" (p. 205, n. 3 for Spell 269), thus missing the relationship of Isis' *3ḫ*-effectiveness to Horus through the grain.

[18] Cf. Seth's impregnation from eating Horus' semen in "The Contendings of Horus and Seth" or the Lady's impregnation through swallowing a splinter in "The Tale of Two Brotherrs," both translated by E. F. Wente in *The Literature of Ancient Egypt*, ed. by W. K. Simpson (New Haven and London, 1972), 120 and 106.

[19] To illustrate, I note here additional terminologies which I perceive for categorizing the notion of *3ḫ*: What she views as primordial and funerary, I call solar and chthonic; what she sees as relating to the primordial and the deceased, I call the cosmic and personal aspects of *3ḫ*; what she terms potential and manifest, I believe can often be represented as the difference between the essence and form of *3ḫ*.

HIEROGLYPHEN OHNE GEHEIMNIS: EINE EINFÜHRUNG IN DIE ALTAEGYPTISCHE SCHRIFT FÜR MUSEUMSBESUCHER UND AEGYPTENTOURISTEN (Kulturgeschichte der antiken Welt 6), by *Karl-Th. Zauzich*. 125pp; 14 illustrations, 8 in color. DM 34.00. Philipp von Zabern, Mainz am Rhein, 1980.

No one can learn how to read hieroglyphs overnight. The average visitor to a museum, moreover, generally

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